EJ FOX



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PROFILE

Design engineer and creative technologist who ships under pressure. I transform complex information into clear interactive visuals and have fun doing it. My work combines journalistic curiosity with an addiction to trying new things—from NBC's election graphics to experimental embedding interfaces. I want to make things no one has seen before with smart, kind people.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Code: JavaScript, Python, Node.js, Vue, React, TypeScript, HTML/CSS, SQL

Graphics: D3, Observable Plot, Three.js, WebGL, Canvas, SVG, TopoJSON

AI/ML: LLM APIs, embedding visualization, context management, vector databases, prompt engineering, tool usage, alternative interfaces

Design & Motion: Illustrator, Photoshop, Final Cut Pro, After Effects, Principle, Figma, Animation (GSAP, Anime.js)

Methods: Rapid prototyping, joy-driven development, component systems, public documentation, performance optimization, video demos

EXPERIENCE

Lenfest AI Fellow

Arizona State University NEWSWELL | 2025 - 2026

Lenfest AI Collaborative and Fellowship Program, with support from OpenAI and Microsoft

- Built an AI-assisted tool that automates ad and content layout for hyperlocal print newspapers
- Gave an Ignite talk on the work at ASU's National Journalism + AI Accelerator (January 2026)
- Demoed the tool to OpenAI, Microsoft, ProPublica and the Boston Globe at the program's demo day

Design Engineer & Creative Technologist

Independent Consultant | 2019 - Present

Select Clients: GitHub • NBC News • CBS News • Washington Post • New York Times • Carnegie Mellon • Stamen

- Specializing in tight-deadline projects that require fast iterative sprints and user testing – especially things no one has ever done before
- Helped CBS News prototype their broadcast touchscreen app, analyzed newspaper front pages for the NY Times, and helped make geographic visualizations with the geniuses at Stamen for Meta
- Comfortable working across design and engineering teams and with a wide array of technology stacks, adapting to everything from fresh startups to enterprise workflows
- Published 50+ Observable notebooks, YouTube livestreams, and blog posts of in-progress work, experiments, and methodology - working in public at every opportunity

Founder

Room 302 Studio | 2023 - Present

Select Clients: The Associated Press • Wildlife Conservation Society • Earth Genome

- Founded prototyping shop focused on providing novel data visualization and analysis methods on tight deadlines

- Built out LLM-powered studio manager as 'AI team member'
- Transform rough ideas into polished demos clients can actually use to gain internal stakeholder support or get funding
- Joined AP team as support for 2024 election coverage, delivered Webby-nominated work
- Helped WCS map the story of coral reefs resisting climate change

Senior Interactive Graphics Specialist

NBC News | 2016 - 2019

- Co-built and was lead designer of the 2018 relaunch of the election-night Big Board, with Michael Small and the NBC News Digital teams; praised by NYTimes as a "newly juiced-up" version, still used today

Graphics Editor

Vocativ | 2014 - 2016

- Scaled output 20x through smart automation (5 monthly → 5 daily)
- Won Knight Foundation grant for Dataproofer validation tool
- Empowered reporters with self-service visualization platform, created data visualization templates, oversaw daily breaking news graphic production

Early Career

- *GitHub (2014)*: Worked as a freelancer with the GitHub team to create "State of the Octoverse" website and visualizations
- *Visual.ly (2011)*: Core team building one of the first visualization-as-a-service platforms

PROJECTS

Subway Builder · Borough Studio (2025 - 2026) – Credited developer on a transit-building game; shipped the desktop build and the Steam release (July 2026)

Decision Desk HQ (2025 - 2026) – Engineering and design on election-results broadcast tools

Global Energy Ownership Tracker · Global Energy Monitor (2025 - 2026) – Interactive explorer for corporate ownership of energy assets: ownership trees, embeddable cards, screener

Paramilitary Leaks (2025) – Explorer and visualizations for a 200 GB leaked militia-chat dataset, credited in Micah Lee's reporting

NYPD misconduct network · WNYC/Gothamist (2021) – Network analysis of civilian-complaint data for an investigation into clusters of officers repeatedly accused of misconduct

Climate TRACE · Earthrise Media (2022) – Maps and data exploration of global emissions-asset data

Ukraine grain · Earth Genome (2022 - 2023) – Scrollytelling data story on global food security

COVIDcast · Carnegie Mellon University Delphi (2020) – Visualization prototypes for public COVID-19 indicators (contributor, Jul–Sep 2020)

Election simulator · Washington Post Opinions (2019 - 2020) – Engineering on an interactive simulator built on David Byler's election model

Dark-money map · Mother Jones (2012) – Interactive map of the super PAC and dark-money universe (co-author)